



CONTROLLED ENTERPRISE DOCUMENT

TBT-31.05 | Dewatering And Pump Operations

MH Construction, INC Enterprise Management System

Document family: TOOLBOX TALK LIBRARY

Document title: TBT-31.05 | Dewatering And Pump Operations

Version: 1.0 | Lifecycle: Rough Draft

Use only after required functional, technical, field-usability, and approval gates are complete.

Control: Version 1.0 | Status Rough Draft | Author and Chief Editor: Matt Ramsey | Co-Editor: Todd Shoeff | Final Approver: Jeremy Thamert

TBT-31.05: Dewatering & Pump Operations

CSI Division: Div 31 | OSHA Reference: 29 CFR 1926.651

Delivery: Mandatory for excavation crews managing groundwater or rain accumulation.

DIRECTIVE — Policy Standard

Personnel shall not work in excavations where water is accumulating unless adequate precautions have been taken, including continuous dewatering and specialized trench protection.

GENERAL ORDER — Procedure

Trash pumps and hoses must be inspected for leaks. Gas-powered pumps must be placed downwind of the trench to prevent carbon monoxide from accumulating in the excavation.

Key Hazards & Mitigation (The 'What If'):

- Carbon Monoxide in the Trench: If a gas pump is placed right on the edge of the trench on a still day, CEO will sink to the bottom. Move the pump at least 10 feet away and position the exhaust downwind.
- Undermining the Shoring: If water is pumping out too fast, it can draw soil from behind the trench box, undermining the surrounding ground. Monitor the discharge water—if it is heavy with silt, slow the pump rate.
- Electrical Shock: If using electric submersible pumps, all connections must be watertight and plugged into a GFCI outlet. Do not handle the pump by its power cord.

FIELD INSTRUCTION — Execution

FIELD INSTRUCTION: Foremen must inspect the placement of all gas-powered equipment near excavations to ensure exhaust cannot enter the trench. Log attendance on MISH-F-10.1.

Attendance Roster (Log on MISH-F-10.1):

Print Name	Signature	Company/Trade